

suddenly. It's usually slowly drained away over long periods of time, bit by bit, penny by penny, so slowly that it's hardly noticeable. It's as if that money never existed to begin with. In other words, it doesn't haunt you. But what if you took that amount of money, organized it into a neat pile in your backyard, and set fire to it? Wouldn't that traumatize you? I bet it would. I want you to start being haunted by Ghost Money, to feel its loss when you spend on unnecessary items. I want this lost money to stand by your bed at night, like Marley over Ebenezer Scrooge, and shake its chains at your financial folly.

How do you bring that kind of Ghost Money back to life? How do you leave behind the suckers who line up for their expensive coffees and magazines and spend their money on a bad habit that will likely kill them? The good news is that it's not too late. Some of that Ghost Money *can* come back to life, if you introduce savvy spending habits now. Because I'll tell you something else about Ghost Money: If it doesn't haunt you now, it'll haunt you later. I believe in Money Karma. This is how it works: If you spend a wad of cash on cappuccinos and magazines in your twenties, there's a good chance you'll be serving coffee or working at a newsstand in your seventies to pay for your retirement. Remember that there is a certain amount of money you need to earn to take care of yourself during your lifetime, and you're going to have to earn it somehow. If you don't want to get a job at Starbucks in your twilight years, stop spending so much money there today. Money knows when it's being wasted. It remembers when it's been disrespected, so keep that karma in mind when you're lining up for your morning fix.

Money Mistake: Friends and Family Ask You for Money

THE FIX: DON'T LEND, GIVE (IF YOU CAN)

There is no greater minefield, no bigger potential for disastrous rifts, than when family lends money to family. So I am often baffled when I get flak on *Shark Tank* for saying money and tears don't mix. In all my years on TV, no one's ever asked me why that's so. I'll tell you now. It's